

Noach 5784 (2)

In פרשת נח, after the excruciating מסירות נפש of serving everyone in the תיבה, it was a devastating experience to come out to a world which had nothing. We know that נח was a צדיק, but for whatever reason (וַיִּקְהַל נֹחַ אִישׁ הָאָדָמָה וַיֹּטֶעַ כָּרֶם (בראשית ט:כ'), and became שיכור, and הם came and saw what happened and he told his two brothers. A famous pasuk: וַיִּקַּח שָׁם יִנְפֹת אֶת הַשָּׂמְלָה וַיְשִׁימוּ עַל שָׂכָם שְׁנֵיהֶם וַיֵּלְכוּ אַחֲרָנִית וַיַּכְסּוּ. The תורה brings a מדרש that says that שם and יפת got a שכר for doing this מצוה of כיבוד אב.

שם's שכר is after the מלחמת גוג ומגוג his offspring will be זוכה to קבורה after they die. What will שם get? שם will get clothing with which one can do the מצוה of ציצית. What's the difference between the two of them? The answer is, וַיִּקַּח שָׁם יִנְפֹת אֶת הַשָּׂמְלָה, that's a grammatically incorrect term. The Torah is specifically saying, "And he took," and it's talking about two people, so it should say ויקחו. The מדרש says שם took it with a מצוה. לעבדדיקע מצוה. He took it because he was trying to do this, and יפת tagged along, he shlepped along to do it, but he did it without any טעם, without any חיות, without any great enthusiasm. So one did a מצוה, לעבדדיקע מצוה, and one did a טויטע מצוה. So guess what, the שכר is equally compensatory. It's מדה כנגד מדה. שם did it with a ברען, with a living מצוה, so therefore he gets a living שכר. But יפת, you did a טויטע מצוה, you get a שכר that after you die, you're going to get buried, which is a big זכות.

If you do a מצוה, do it with your whole heart. Do it the way that שם did it. That's the way to do a מצוה.